

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Equity Is a Distribution, Not an Average

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C42
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Assess education equity through distributions, intersectional groups, access, participation, learning, resources, and uncertainty—not averages alone.

Why it matters

National or district averages can conceal severe disadvantage and direct resources away from learners facing the greatest barriers.

Illustrative application

A district compares learning and access distributions across location, disability, gender, and socioeconomic groups.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.